ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

NC(V) LEVEL 4

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PRACTICE EXAM · MARKING GUIDELINE

MARKS: 100

Marking guideline for the Academic Central NC(V) Level 4 English First Additional Language practice exam.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the NC(V) subject guidelines for NC(V) Level 4. It is not a Department of Higher Education and Training marking guideline.

How to mark: each ✓ is one mark. Accept answers in the student's own words if the meaning is correct. Do not penalise spelling in Section A unless the meaning is lost. Section D is marked with the rubric at the end of this memo.

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION

QUESTION 1

1.1	Chatbots answer customer queries ✓; software writes reports ✓; robots work on factory floors through the night ✓	(3)
1.2	Headlines warn that AI may replace millions of workers, so he or she may not find a job ✓	(1)
1.3	People predicted the end of bank tellers / that tellers would lose their jobs ✓✓. Instead, branches became cheaper, banks opened more branches ✓ and tellers moved to advising customers ✓.	(4)
1.4	Technology takes over some tasks of a job ✓, so workers do different work rather than losing their jobs completely ✓.	(2)
1.5	Jobs made up of predictable, repetitive tasks ✓; any TWO: capturing data ✓; sorting parcels ✓; answering the same question many times a day	(3)
1.6	South Africa already has high unemployment ✓, so people who lose jobs will struggle to find new ones / to retrain ✓.	(2)
1.7	Solar technicians; drone operators; data analysts; robotics technicians (½ each) ✓✓	(2)
1.8	Machines are good at physical, repetitive tasks ✓, but they lack human skills such as empathy and communication ✓, which are needed to deal with people / solve unexpected problems ✓.	(3)
1.9	Not keeping up / not learning new skills ("standing still") ✓✓	(2)
1.10	Instead of fearing technology or trying to beat it ✓, learn to control and use it as a tool to do your work better ✓.	(2)
1.11	Optimistic ✓ – "more hopeful" ✓	(2)
1.12	Fact, e.g. ATMs spread in the 1980s and 1990s / South Africa has high unemployment ✓; opinion, e.g. "the story is more complicated – and more hopeful" / "The real danger … is … standing still" ✓	(2)
1.13	Open answer: names skills from the text with a brief, sensible explanation ✓✓	(2)
		[30]

SECTION B: SUMMARY

QUESTION 2

SEVEN points in full sentences (1 mark each), plus up to 3 marks for language:

1. Research the company. ✓
2. Study the advertisement and prepare examples of your skills. ✓
3. Practise answering common questions aloud. ✓
4. Prepare questions to ask the panel. ✓
5. Plan your route and arrive early. ✓
6. Dress neatly and appropriately. ✓
7. Take copies of your CV, certificates and ID. ✓

Content ✓✓✓✓✓✓✓ (7) Language ✓✓✓ (3). Deduct 1 mark if longer than 80 words or if the word count is missing. (10)

[10]

SECTION C: LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

QUESTION 3

3.1 61 ÷ 27 ≈ 2,26 ✓, so a little more than twice as likely (34 percentage points more) ✓ (2)

3.2 A qualification (skills) helps you to get a job ✓, but practical experience helps you to keep it / to grow in your career ✓. (2)

3.3 So that readers know the source and how reliable the data is ✓ – a larger sample is more representative, and readers are not misled into thinking it is real data ✓. (2)

3.4 No ✓ – 61% of qualified young people found work within 12 months ✓, much higher than the 27% without a qualification; the headline is sensational / misleading ✓. (3)

3.5 The shortlisted candidates will be interviewed ✓ by the panel on Friday ✓. (2)

3.6 The lecturer asked whether / if ✓ we / they had updated ✓ our / their CVs ✓. (3)

3.7 The company's decision ✓ to automate the warehouse shocked the workers ✓. (2)

3.8 Complex sentence ✓ (1)

3.9 "Cheap" can suggest poor quality / negative connotation ✓; "affordable" suggests good value at a reasonable price / positive connotation ✓. (2)

3.10 The company's ✓ new policy affects three groups of workers: ✓ drivers, packers and clerks. ✓ (capital letter, apostrophe, colon, commas, full stop) (3)

3.11 We want to employ / recruit ✓ many new staff members as soon as possible ✓. (2)

3.12 It adds a further / stronger point to the argument ✓ (1)

[25]

SECTION D: WRITING – RUBRICS

Essay (20)	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak
Content and planning (12)	10–12: original, relevant, well-developed ideas; strong introduction and conclusion	7–9: relevant ideas with good detail	5–6: mostly relevant, some detail	0–4: few ideas, often off the topic
Language, style and editing (6)	6: varied vocabulary and sentences; very few errors	4–5: good vocabulary, few errors	3: simple but clear; some errors	0–2: many errors; meaning unclear
Structure (2)	2: clear paragraphs, logical order, correct length		0–1: poor paragraphing or far too short / long	

Transactional text (15)	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak
Content, planning and format (9)	8–9: all requirements covered; correct format; correct register	6–7: most requirements; format mostly correct	4–5: some requirements; format partly correct	0–3: task not understood; no format
Language, style and editing (6)	6: very few errors	4–5: few errors	3: some errors	0–2: many errors

QUESTION 4

4.1 Argumentative: clear stance in the introduction; at least three well-supported arguments (e.g. new jobs in solar, robotics and data; loss of routine jobs; need for retraining); counter-argument addressed; strong conclusion. [20]

4.2 Descriptive / reflective: the person introduced; specific examples of their influence; how it shaped the writer's career choice; reflection. [20]

4.3 Narrative with the given title; believable characters, suspense and a turning point linked to the interview; clear resolution. [20]

[20]

QUESTION 5

5.1 **Covering letter** – sender's address and date; recipient (The HR Manager, Ithemba Engineering Services, PO Box 1100, East London, 5200); "Dear Sir/Madam"; subject line naming the post and reference; where the advertisement was seen; qualification, skills and experience matched to the post; availability for an interview; reference to the attached CV; "Yours faithfully"; signature and name. [15]

5.2 **Report** – title; to, from, date; introduction / terms of reference; findings (causes, e.g. late delivery of materials, poor planning, staff absence, equipment breakdown) under headings; conclusion; numbered recommendations; signature. Formal, objective language. [15]

5.3 **Notice and agenda** – notice: heading, what, when, where, who may attend, contact person; agenda: name of meeting / workshop, date, time and venue; numbered items in logical order (welcome, opening, items such as CV writing, interview skills, workplace ethics, questions, closure). [15]

[15]

TOTAL: 100

END OF MARKING GUIDELINE